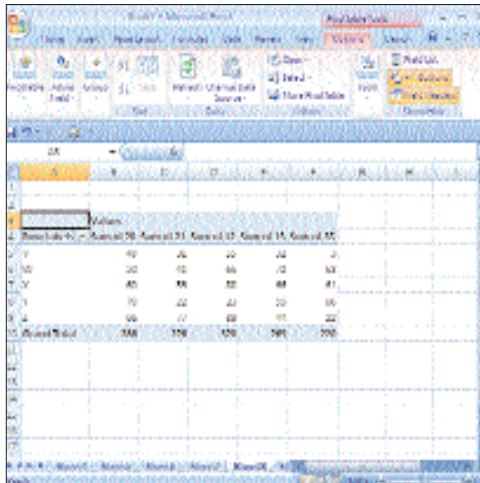


tables. The Pivot Table checks through the various cells in the rows and columns and figures out the headings.



Pivot table creation helps in accessing data

To create a Pivot Table, click the Insert Ribbon and then click PivotTable > PivotTable. Highlight the area of cells containing the table. The next step will involve telling Excel what fields to use in the Pivot Table. Your Pivot Table is ready. You can also choose to make a Pivot Chart in a similar fashion.

Widen The Audience

Excel spreadsheets are no longer limited to local drives and then mailing them to your recipients. With the Publish to Excel Services, people on the Internet or a network can access the spreadsheet. To do this, click on the Office Button at the left top corner of your screen and click Publish > Excel Services.

External Data Sources

The latest Office suite allows the user to grab information from external sources such as the Internet. An example of a connection is the MSN MoneyCentral Investor Currency Rates. To make a connection, click on the Data Ribbon and click Connections. Click Add and choose one of the available connections, or choose to load a third-party data source. Click Open, and Excel will retrieve the information from the source and dump it onto the spreadsheet.

In the same manner, data can be acquired from other sources such as SQL servers. This option is available when you click on Data > From External Sources.

Access files can be used to import data from by clicking on the From Access button on Get External Data. Similarly, the From Web button opens up a Web query where you can select a table and have it imported into Excel.

Visual Relations

When formulas are used for calculating numbers, there is no clear way to find out how a particular value is derived. To look at the cells affecting the value in a visual representation, first click on the result cell, then click on the Formulas Ribbon, and finally click Trace Precedents. Lines and highlighted boxes will be drawn displaying the various elements involved in the calculation.

Evaluating Existing Formulas

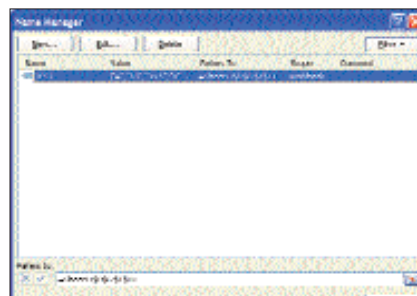
Chances are you might wonder if the calculations made to get a certain result are incorrect. It could be human error, and you would want to see at what step the calculations go wrong. The Evaluate Formula option, which can be accessed from the Formulas Ribbon, lets you do just that. Click on the Evaluate Formula button while highlighting the cell with the formula. The next window will show you all the steps involved in the calculation.

Lighten Up Your Worksheets

Using a plain black and white table can be boring, so themes are available which can be used to colour up tables in a workbook. Office 2007's themes are applied as you move your mouse pointer over them. So click on the Page Layout Ribbon and then click on Themes, and select a theme from the list. Themes are add-ons available on Microsoft's Excel site.

The Name Manager

The Name Manager is like a database of certain tables in the various spreadsheets in your book. It is very useful to quickly gain access to these tables. You can add entries by first starting the Name Manager, which can be found under the Formulas Ribbon. Click the Name Manager button and give a name for the selection you're about to add. Next, for the Refers To entry, enter the range of the cells manually, or highlight them using the mouse. Click OK and the selection will be added to the database.



Maintaining groups of selected cells is easy

Bet You Didn't Know

Microsoft Excel

- ❑ Excel 2007's rightmost bottommost cell is XFD1048576.
- ❑ The first Excel release 1.0 was made for the Macintosh in 1985!
- ❑ Microsoft has abandoned using Easter Eggs in their products, including Excel, to avoid any security glitches or breaches as per their Trustworthy Computing programme.
- ❑ Excel 97 had a flight simulator as an Easter Egg, and Excel 2000, Dev Hunter!

Add-ons For Excel

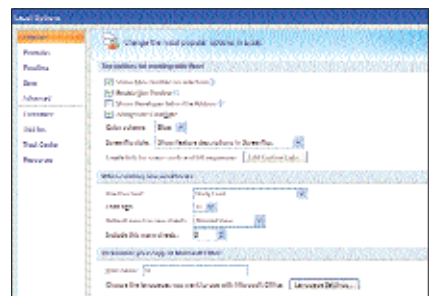
Excel supports add-ons, which can be loaded and unloaded according to your needs. There are even add-ons which let you read data from PDF files and get this data into Excel. To enable or disable add-ons, click on the Office Button and then on Excel Options. Click on Add-ins, and a large list of available add-ons will be displayed. Additional Add-ins are being developed and can be downloaded from Microsoft's Excel site.

The Office 2007 Open XML Format

The latest Office suite stores data in its files in a different manner. Excel inherits the same characteristics. An Excel file, for example, when renamed to .zip, can be opened by any file compression application. All the media—such as images and audio used—can be accessed. The clear advantage to this is that the files are obviously smaller, as they are compressed. The other advantage could be, in case of data corruption, it would be possible to extract the undamaged content. Corrupted older Office documents would mean complete loss.

Changing Names

During the installation of Office 2007, you are required to enter your name. The same name will be used as



Changing the name from the licensing name